Hopes, Expectations, and Vision

Senior Practicum: ED 449

Spring 2023

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My Vision and Focus for the Course

Welcome to the most fulfilling, most enriching, most challenging class I can imagine. When we speak of rigor we normally think of hours of homework or difficulty of text, but senior practicum is more rigorous than any of that: it's not merely hard work, but *heart work*. This class will change you. It will make you into a teacher. Jesus grew "grace for grace" and "line upon line."[1] So will you.

Whatever standards and outcomes I may put for the department and the university and the state accreditors, here are my most honest "educational outcomes" for this class:

1. Course participants will see the path toward the character and effectiveness of masterful teachers—and will begin to walk it;
2. And they will begin to understand the unique mission of BYUI in developing, (and their unique charge in becoming) educational leaders and innovators.

It's worth taking a moment to compare this to the mission statement of the Department of Early, Elementary, and Special Education: "Follow the example of the Savior to become outstanding educators who empower learners to reach their divine potential."* By the way, that's my job too. My goal is to help you reach your divine potential.

I'm so glad you're here. Buckle up.

Brother Benjamin Pacini (BroPa)

Defining Success

This may be the first class you have taken in which you can earn an A and be asked to repeat the course. In order to move on to student teaching, the following ED 449 requirements need to be met:

- Pass all coursework for the class.
- Submit a unit plan that is to standard.
- Be rated as possessing the appropriate dispositions and mindsets for teaching.
- Receive adequate scores during a formal evaluation of your teaching.
- Submit a portfolio that is judged as adequate, including the senior interview and presentation.

Course policies:

- **Late Policy:** I'm normally pretty chill about late work, but for senior practicum the goal is to show me that you can be professional about work expectations. As such, while you can submit work late, you should consider me as your professional supervisor. Communicate early. Note: work that is submitted as best effort is allowed to be resubmitted as many times as possible until the student receives the desired grade.
- **Outside Work:** There is no formal rule about outside work or credit loads for other course. I recommend, however, that you be wise. Student average pass rates tend to begin to fall around

[1] See John 1, 2nd Peter 1, and D&C 4.

15 hours of outside work, or 12 credits total. I trust you, but would encourage you to be wise.

- **Attendance policy:** Course attendance is mandatory. Any classes missed are required to be made up, and no more than 1 seminar and 2 practicum days may be made up total. Exceptions will be judged on a case-by-case basis only, and are not often approved.
- **Substitute teaching:** Substitute teaching is one of the very best preparation practices that a teacher candidate can receive. Please be aware, however, that there are policies around substitute teaching that require that any substitute teaching be approved by me. If you have questions, please let me know.
- **Course books:** You will need access to three books, listed in the course booklist: Teach Like a Champion (TLAC) and SEL and the Brain (SELATB). TLAC can be any version 2.0 or higher. (Note that TLAC has an online option through BYUI library that is free.)
- **Placement policies**: Placement will be explained in class.
- **Carpooling**: I strongly recommend you carpool–both because your car group will become dear friends and vital supports, and also because I know the cost of gas.
- **Lockers:** The next line contains invisible text. Highlight it to view the secret instructions.

Assignments & Projects

A typical week:	Time on Assignment
10% Attendance	Active, engaged presence in class, and your submission of notes. I highly recommend you create a teacher blog, or running record of some kind. Should take 5-10 minutes each week if you are consistent with notes.
10% Minor Assignments	Various small assignments will be in this grading category, including the ethics quiz, the IPLP goals document, and dispositions self-assessments.
15% Applied Readings	Read 1 skill from TLAC and SELatB each week, then choose one to implement. Write a brief reflection and submit. < 1hour per week.
25% Observations	You will have five total observations this semester. Full credit awarded for completion.
40% Major Assignments	Your senior portfolio and your UPOD will be divided up by week. This is the bulk of your coursework. 3-5 hours per week.

Extra Credit: There are a limited number of extra credit opportunities for this class. See the extra credit assignment in Canvas. Note: extra credit must be approved in advance, and extra credit is more likely to be approved early in the semester (as an insurance policy) rather than later (as a bailout).

Honor Code and Dress and Grooming: I enforce the honor code and dress and grooming standards. We will review in class, but you should expect me to enforce these.

On Squeaking: The squeaky wheel gets the grease. As such, be ye squeaky my children. There's a reason you have my number, email, and zoom contact info[2]. Use them. You cannot overcommunicate with me.

Sensitive Issues: I intend to address hard issues. I hope I will do it well. I will need your maturity and your resilience. You can have hard conversations, and do so well.

Standard Disclosures: There are several standard disclosures sent out by BYU-Idaho each semester. You should read them, and assume they are part of this syllabus.

Art Note: The artwork in this document is from Ben Crowder, a friend and favorite artist of mine. If you find the titles, you might see why I find them so meaningful. If you do, would love to hear.

[2] 801.618.7865. Pacinib@byui.edu Hinckley 273. Zoom me a message first–it's the easiest way to get a hold of me.